HILCHOT SHABBAT

Juice, Pickles & Lemons: Squeezing on Shabbat

Given Thursday 14 May 2026 · Hilchot Shabbat Siman 320 — מלאכת דש

Topic: מלאכת דש — Threshing and Squeezing **Siman:** (320) שכ **Seifim covered tonight:** Seif 1, 2, 3, beginning of Seif 4 (and Seif 7 introduced) **Source text:** Shulchan Aruch with Rema, Mishna Berura, and Bi'ur Halacha

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Where We Are in Hilchot Shabbat

So far in Hilchot Shabbat we have covered:

- Hotza'ah (carrying — Siman 301)
- Muktzeh
- Boneh and Soter (building and destroying)
- Tzad and Shochet (trapping, killing)
- Kosher and Matir (tying, untying)
- Bishul (cooking — Siman 318)
- Borer, Meraked, and Zoreh (selecting, sieving, winnowing — Siman 319, just completed)

Now we begin Siman 320 — Dash (threshing), with all its derivatives — primarily the laws of squeezing.

What is Melechet Dash?

The Av Melacha

Dash in the Mishkan is the fifth melacha. To make the dye for the Mishkan's roof:

1. Plant
2. Plow
3. Harvest
4. Gather the stalks
5. **Dash** — thresh the seeds from the stalks
6. Zoreh — winnow with wind
7. Borer — select good from bad
8. Tochen — grind
9. Meraked — sieve
10. Knead → Bake (as dye)

The essence of Dash: **extracting something edible from an inedible encasement.**

The Toledot (Derivatives)

Toledah	Action	Status
Extracting kernels from stalks	The Av itself	d'Oraita
Mifarek (extracting)	Milking a human or animal	d'Oraita Toledah
Squeezing liquids from fruit	Extracting juice from olives/grapes especially	d'Oraita Toledah

Key Principles

Only Gidulei Karka (D'Oraita)

אין דישה אלא בגידולי קרקע

Dash applies only to **things that grow from the ground**. Mid'Oraita, it doesn't apply to non-plant matter. However:

- **Milking mammals** is still d'Oraita per most Rishonim, because animals (and humans) get their nutrients from the ground — so they are considered *gidulei karka* in an extended sense
- **Squeezing liquid from a woolen garment to use the liquid** = d'Oraita Dash (wool is gidulei karka)
- **Squeezing liquid from a synthetic fiber** = NOT d'Oraita Dash (synthetic isn't gidulei karka)

The Overlap with Melaben (Laundering)

This siman will also touch on **Melaben** (laundering) because an essential aspect of laundering clothes is the **squeezing out of liquid**.

Action	Dash applies	Melaben applies
Squeezing fruit	✅	❌
Squeezing a wet garment to USE the liquid	✅ (d'Oraita if wool)	✅
Squeezing a wet garment NOT for the liquid	❌ (not Dash)	✅ (still Melaben because squeezing is part of laundering)

When discussing garments, both melachot must be considered.

The Three Categories of Fruit (Foundational)

The Gemara establishes three categories of fruit for the law of squeezing:

Category 1 — Olives and Grapes (Zetim v'Anavim)

Status: Forbidden d'Oraita to squeeze.

Why is this a Toledah of Dash?

- You had a liquid contained within a solid encasement
- You extract the liquid, leaving the solid behind

- Just like Dash extracts wheat from stalks, this extracts juice from a solid fruit

Why specifically these two?

- The Torah recognizes their liquids as **mashkin** (formal liquids)
- They have their own status as liquids — special brachot, special halachot
- Olive oil and wine are formal mashkin
- Therefore extracting them = liquid from solid = Dash

Category 2 — Strawberries, Pomegranates, and Commonly Squeezed Fruits

Status: Forbidden mid'Rabbanan to squeeze.

Why only d'Rabbanan?

- The Gemara identifies tutim v'rimonim (strawberries, pomegranates) as the prototypes
- **Rashi's reason:** *lav orchaihu behachi* — it's not the common practice (in those days) to squeeze them, so what comes out is not formally a "mashke"
- Treated as **food from food** (ochel from ochel) at the Torah level — therefore no d'Oraita Dash
- But Chachamim forbade as a precaution against confusion with Category 1

The Chayei Adam's Challenging Position (200-300 years ago)

The Chayei Adam argued that nowadays — when oranges, apples, and many fruits are commonly squeezed — those fruits should be d'Oraita.

Almost all poskim rejected this. The Torah's category of "mashke" is fixed: only olive oil and wine. Modern fruits remain at d'Rabbanan level no matter how common their juice has become.

Practical Today (Category 2 includes):

- Strawberries, pomegranates
- Apples, oranges, grapefruits, pears
- Cranberries, lychees
- Any commonly-squeezed-for-juice fruit

Category 3 — Fruits Not Commonly Squeezed

Status: Permitted to squeeze on Shabbat.

Examples discussed:

- **Figs** — fibrous and fleshy, ~80% water but high sugar content; not suited to juice; better for pastes, jams, dried (develot). The Mishna's reference to *develot* (dried figs) suggests the lack of juice tradition is ancient.
- **Dates** — also generally not juiced; processed into silan/honey instead
- **Possibly melon/watermelon** — though even this has become more common today; status debatable

Quick Reference Table

Category	Examples	Squeezing Status	Liquid Oozed Out On Its Own (Mashkin Shezavu)
1 — Zetim v'Anavim	Olives, grapes	d'Oraita forbidden	Forbidden regardless of intent (mid'Rabbanan + Muktzeh)
2 — Tutim v'Rimonim	Strawberries, pomegranates, apples, oranges, etc.	d'Rabbanan forbidden	Forbidden ONLY if designated for squeezing
3 — Other fruits	Figs, dates, etc.	Permitted	Permitted

Gezeirat Mashkin Shezavu (Liquids That Flowed Out)

A critical secondary principle: **what about liquids that ooze out of the fruit on their own, without any active squeezing?**

The Setup

- A non-Jew squeezed olives on Shabbat (no instruction from you), or
- Very ripe grapes/olives gushed liquid on their own
- The liquid is sitting there — you didn't do anything

The Gezeira

The Chachamim were worried: if we permit such liquid, you might come to actively squeeze the remaining olives/grapes. So they forbade.

Category	Designated to Eat	Designated to Squeeze
1 (olives, grapes)	❌ Forbidden	❌ Forbidden
2 (tutim, etc.)	✅ Permitted	❌ Forbidden
3	✅ Permitted	✅ Permitted (not subject to gezeira)

The Muktzeh Dimension

The liquid that flowed out from Category 1 grapes/olives is also **muktzeh** — a double prohibition (can't drink it AND can't move it).

Why Even a Gezeira on Category 2?

This is a *gezeira ligzeira* (decree upon a decree), since squeezing Category 2 is itself only d'Rabbanan. The Chachamim still extended it — the limitation being that the designation must be for liquid.

Important Limitation

Surface moisture — a tiny amount of moisture on the surface is insignificant and not subject to this gezeira.

The Shulchan Aruch Seifim

Seif 1 — The Three Categories Codified

זיתים וענבים אסור לסחטן

Olives and grapes — forbidden to squeeze.

ואם יצאו מעצמם אסורים אפילו לא עמדו לאכילה

If liquid flows of its own accord — still forbidden, even if you only intended to eat the fruit (mid'Rabbanan, gezeirat mashkin shezavu).

ותותים ורימונים אסור לסחטן

Strawberries and pomegranates — forbidden to squeeze (mid'Rabbanan).

ואם יצאו מעצמן: אם עומדים לאכילה מותר, אם עומדים למשקין אסור

If liquid flows of its own accord:

- Designated to eat → permitted
- Designated to drink → forbidden

ושאר כל הפירות מותר לסחטן

All other fruit — permitted to squeeze.

The Rema — Local Customs and Category 2

ובמקום שנהגו לסחוט איזה פירות לשתות ממימיו מחמת צמא או תענוג דינו כתותים ורמונים

Where a particular fruit IS commonly squeezed for pleasure or refreshment, it takes Category 2 status in that place.

Example given by Rav Falk many years ago: Carrots in Israel. (Practically complicated by tochen issues, but theoretically the principle applies — what's "commonly squeezed" varies by region.)

The Mishna Berura's Modification

The Mishna Berura disagreed with the Rema's strict locality reading. He held:

- **If a fruit is not squeezed somewhere because of cultural/taste preference** → Category 3 there
- **If a fruit is not squeezed somewhere because they don't have enough OR it's too expensive** → still Category 2 universally (because if they had access, they would squeeze it)

Mishna Berura's example: Pears. Pears in some European cities ~100 years ago were squeezed; in others not — only because of supply. The Mishna Berura held pears were already Category 2 *everywhere*, and time has proven him right — pear juice is now widespread.

He also discussed apples, agreeing they are firmly Category 2.

Medicinal Squeezing Doesn't Count

אבל אם נהגו לסחטן לרפואה לבד אין לחוש

If a fruit is squeezed only for medicinal purposes, it doesn't establish Category 2 status — only squeezing for pleasure/refreshment counts.

Squeezing Into the Mouth — Derech Achila

A critical practical question: **can I extract juice from a fruit by sucking it?**

Universal Agreement: In the Mouth = Permitted

If you put a fruit in your mouth and squeeze with your teeth, extracting the juice in your mouth → **everyone agrees this is permitted, even for olives and grapes.**

This is **derech achila** — the way of eating.

The Disputed Middle Case: Sucking with Lips Outside the Mouth

וכל זה דווקא לסחוט אסור אבל מותר למצוץ בפיו מן הפירות המשקים שבהן

You hold a grape (or any fruit) at your lips and suck the juice out without putting the whole fruit in your mouth. Permitted?

Position	Source	Ruling
Permitted	Most Rishonim	It's like derech achila — lips are an extension of the mouth; or the action is so different from normal squeezing that it qualifies as a major shinui
Forbidden	Some Rishonim (Agudah and others)	Until the fruit is fully in the mouth it isn't derech achila — and you're still extracting liquid externally

Why Not Like Breastfeeding?

One might compare this to a mother squeezing milk into a child's mouth (which IS forbidden as we'll see later). But the cases are different:

- A child sucking is the normal way the child drinks
- That is derech yenika
- Adults sucking fruit with lips is not the normal way of consuming

Halacha L'Maaseh

Category	Sucking with Lips Outside the Mouth
Category 1 (olives, grapes)	Should be machmir — don't do it
Category 2 and 3 (oranges, lemons, etc.)	Permitted

So if you have an ulcer and want to suck a lemon for relief → permitted. If you want to suck a grape with your lips → be machmir. If you put the grape fully in your mouth and squeeze with teeth → always permitted.

Lollipops

A separate question entirely. No extraction issue:

- It's a single solid being dissolved in the mouth
- No liquid is being extracted from a solid

- Permitted

Seif 2 — Already-Crushed Olives and Grapes; Wine in a Barrel

Already-Crushed Fruits

זיתים וענבים שנתרסקו מערב שבת משקים היוצאים מהם מותרים

Olives and grapes that were fully crushed before Shabbat — the liquid that continues to ooze out on Shabbat is permitted.

Why Different from Seif 1?

- Seif 1: Whole, intact olives/grapes — there's still a real risk you might squeeze further. So the Chachamim forbade the oozed liquid.
- Seif 2: Already fully crushed before Shabbat. Not much liquid remains, and even if you squeezed, it would not reach d'Oraita levels. The Chachamim did not extend the gezeira here.

Grapes Above a Wine Barrel

ואפילו אם לא נתרסקו כל צרכן מערב שבת, אם יש יין בגיגית שהענבים בתוכה אף על פי שהענבים מתבקעים בשבת בגיגית מותר לשתותו

Even if the grapes weren't fully crushed — if they sit in a barrel of wine and ooze liquid that **immediately mixes into the existing wine**, you may drink the wine.

The principle: What oozes out is immediately *batel* (nullified) in the existing wine of the barrel. The drops that come out never have an independent existence as forbidden liquid — they enter the wine instantaneously.

Why Doesn't דבר שיש לו מתירין Block This?

Normally, a thing that *will* become permitted (דבר שיש לו מתירין — like Chametz after Pesach) does NOT nullify even in 1000 parts.

So why does the oozing wine nullify here, given that after Shabbat it would be permitted anyway?

Answer: דבר שיש לו מתירין applies only when the forbidden substance had a **moment of independent existence** before mixing. Here, the drops never had that moment — they emerged directly into the wine, instantly nullified.

Practical Implication

If the wine were flowing through a slope and only later reaching the barrel, the drops would have a moment of independent existence and become forbidden. Only direct, immediate mixing creates the heter.

Seif 3 — Wine from Grape Skins and Seeds (Temed)

חרצנים וזגים שנתן עליהם מים לעשות תמד מותר בשבת לשתותן

Grape skins and seeds that were soaked in water to extract their wine-flavor — permitted to drink on Shabbat.

Why Permitted?

- Same logic as Seif 2 — the wine flavor immediately mixes with the water
- No moment of independent forbidden existence

אפילו נתן בהם מים ויצאו מעצמם גם כן מותר לשתותן

Even if more wine flows out on its own from the soaked skins — still permitted to drink. Since only the skins and seeds remain (the main wine was already extracted), anything that flows out is permitted.

Seif 4 (Beginning) — Squeezing Onto Food

This is the **major practical principle** of the whole chapter. We'll cover the foundation tonight and complete it next week.

The Gemara's Foundational Statement (Shabbat)

אמר רבי זירא אמר רב חייא בר אשי אמר רב סוחט אדם אשכול של ענבים לתוך הקדרה אבל לא לתוך הקערה

Rav: One may squeeze a cluster of grapes into a *kederah*, but not into a *kearah*.

Vessel	Contents	Status
Kederah	Pot **with food in it**	✅ Permitted to squeeze into
Kearah	Empty bowl (no food)	❌ Forbidden

The Underlying Principle

משקה הבא אל האוכל כאוכל דמי

"A liquid that comes into food has the status of food."

The full logic:

1. Dash forbids extracting a *liquid* from a *solid*
2. When you squeeze grapes onto a salad, the liquid emerges and immediately enters the food
3. The purpose is to add flavor to the salad — the liquid is integral to the food
4. Halachically, that liquid is treated as **food**, not as a liquid
5. Therefore the action is **food from food**, not liquid from food
6. Food from food = no Dash

What Squeezing into an Empty Bowl Looks Like

The liquid emerges as a distinct, independent liquid → liquid from solid → full Dash → forbidden.

Kvashim u'Shlakot (Pickles and Cooked Vegetables) — A Separate Discussion

A second case the Gemara raises: **squeezing pickles or cooked vegetables (which absorbed external liquid)**.

Posek	When squeezing for the vegetable itself (to discard the liquid)	When squeezing for the liquid (to drink/use it)
Rav	Permitted	Forbidden d'Rabbanan
Shmuel	Permitted (whether pickled or cooked)	Forbidden d'Rabbanan
Rabbi Yochanan	Permitted	**Forbidden d'Oraita** (chayav chatat)

The d'Oraita position is difficult to explain — there's much discussion in the Rishonim about why this would be Torah-level since the absorbed liquid isn't even native to the vegetable.

Rabbeinu Chananel's Challenging Position

Rabbeinu Chananel made **two radical claims**:

Claim 1 — Halacha Follows Rabbi Yochanan

Generally הלכה כרבי יוחנן (when Rabbi Yochanan argues with Rav or Shmuel individually).

Claim 2 — Rabbi Yochanan Disagrees with the Earlier Halacha Too

Rabbeinu Chananel held Rabbi Yochanan is disputing not just kvashim but also the *original* principle (משקה הבא אל האוכל כאוכל דמי). So according to him, you cannot squeeze grapes onto a salad either.

Universal Rejection

All other Rishonim disagreed with both claims:

1. **On Halacha:** Rav AND Shmuel both rule leniently → majority rules. The general rule of הלכה כרבי יוחנן applies when he disputes one Amora, not two.
2. **On Scope:** Even if you posken like Rabbi Yochanan for kvashim, he's only disputing the kvashim case — not the broader principle of squeezing into food.

Practical Halacha (Tonight's Practical Conclusion)

The Shulchan Aruch in Seif 4:

מותר לסחוט אשכול ענבים תוך קדרה שיש בה תבשיל כדי לתקן האוכל, דהוי ליה משקה הבא לאוכל וכאוכל דמי, אבל אם אין בתבשיל אסור

You may squeeze a cluster of grapes into a pot that contains food, to enhance the food — because the liquid going onto food has the status of food. But into an empty bowl is forbidden.

The Shulchan Aruch then brings Rabbeinu Chananel's stricter view as a secondary opinion:

ולרבינו חננאל כל שהוא צריך למימיהן חייב חטאת, אפילו סחט לקדרה שיש בה אוכל, ולדבריו סוחט אשכול ענבים נמי אסור

The Bottom Line

Action	Sefardi and Ashkenazi Mainstream	Rabbeinu Chananel
Squeezing grapes onto a salad	✅ Permitted	❌ Forbidden d'Oraita
Squeezing olives onto food	✅ Permitted	❌ Forbidden d'Oraita
Squeezing lemon onto fish	✅ Permitted	(Not d'Oraita category)

המחמיר תבוא עליו ברכה — *"One who is stringent is blessed".*

For **Category 1** (olives and grapes specifically), since Rabbeinu Chananel's position is at the d'Oraita level, **one should preferably be machmir and not squeeze them directly onto food**.

For other fruits (Category 2 and 3), squeezing directly onto food is fully permitted with no concern.

Practical Summary

Can I Squeeze on Shabbat?

Action	Status
Squeeze grapes/olives in an empty bowl	❌ d'Oraita
Squeeze strawberries/oranges/apples in an empty bowl	❌ d'Rabbanan
Squeeze figs/dates in an empty bowl	✅ Permitted
Squeeze grapes/olives directly onto food	✅ Permitted (but lechatchila be machmir)
Squeeze lemon/orange onto salad or fish	✅ Permitted
Squeeze with teeth in the mouth (any fruit)	✅ Permitted (derech achila)
Squeeze with lips outside the mouth (Cat. 1)	❌ Be machmir
Squeeze with lips outside the mouth (Cat. 2, 3)	✅ Permitted
Drink wine that flowed naturally from grapes on Shabbat (uncrushed)	❌ Mashkin shezavu
Drink liquid from pre-crushed grapes that continued oozing	✅ Permitted

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Coming Up Next Week

- **Seif 4 continued** — more details on squeezing into food vs. squeezing into something that then goes into food (the "two-step" question)
- **Seif 5** — additional details on this principle

- **Seif 6 — Lemons (the shortest seif in Shulchan Aruch)**

  מותר לסחוט לימונים — *"It is permitted to squeeze lemons"*

- Why lemons are different from all other fruits
- The major Acharonim's discussion of the lemon question over the past few centuries

There is no shiur next week. We'll resume after that.

Shabbat Shalom

Watch or listen to this shiur: youtu.be/YcjDAxM8YYE · More shiurim: rabbikada.com